

Things to remember about the counselor recommendation

- 1) Remember the counselor recommendation needs to talk about your involvement at school (outside of class). This can include the following themes: participation in extracurricular activities, leadership positions, community service involvement, and special academic recognition.
- 2) The recommendation letter needs to be written by the school college counselor or a teacher holding a special rank within the school. This can be your school principal, deputy principal, head of department, guidance and counseling teacher, etc. (Or just about any teacher who you feel would serve best as your counselor. For more guidance, consult with your mentor)
- 3) Remember to highlight the character traits you want to talk about in the recommendation, and ensure you illustrate them.
- 4) Since your counselor is also the one writing your Common App fee waiver request, you can talk about your family's financial situation in the last paragraphs (once you're done talking about your involvement in school)

Example:

Fulani also qualified for our needy students' bursary fund for three of the four years at Friends Kamusinga, by the value of need as well as merit. He had his tuition fees waived since his mother was unable to contribute enough to cover them. The boarding fee, which was always to the tune of around ten thousand shillings a year, roughly one hundred dollars, was more manageable for them to commit. The family does not have enough money to save, much less live on. By the value of his outstanding grades and extracurricular endeavors, he never had to worry about his standing on the bursary committee each year.

Here's an example of a counselor recommendation (it is incomplete though/ I just want you to get an idea of what is expected of you)

To the Admissions Office,

RE: COUNSELOR'S RECOMMENDATION FOR NGUNDI EDITH WAYUA, COMMON APP ID 20612017

The academic story of Edith Wayua Ngundi, admission number 9927, is a long one. As her class teacher, I can tell this story well. I have known Edith closely as I have been her counselor and Geography teacher for all the four years she has been at Loreto High School Limuru. (Remember

to talk about your relationship with the applicant. Where do you know each other from? How long have you known each other?) In my opinion, Edith is a student worthy of many praises. She has always been a strong student, an excellent writer of ideas, a coherent speaker, a polite individual, and, overall, one of my favorite people to know. *(Briefly talk about the applicant in such a way that we can understand why you would bother writing a recommendation letter for them)* I wish to assess some of her meaningful contributions on an academic level, extracurricular level, and level of leadership and service to the school, hoping that this will further aid your evaluation of her competence.

Edith has always been a top performer in examinations, staying well above the A grade average. *(First character trait: BRILLIANT, Theme: SPECIAL ACADEMIC RECOGNITION, followed by an illustration)* Comparing her to peers proves that she was one of the best of 2017, taking the 4th position in the school and 55th position nationally. This is more impressive because said class emerged as the best performing class in KCSE since the early 2000s. She has also received recognition in the regional capacity for being the best in Physics, Mathematics, Kiswahili, and Art and Design in the regional examinations, the Central Kenya National Schools Examination (CEKENAS), over the four years. She also won regional and national subject contests in Physics and Chemistry in Forms 3 and 4, which constitute contest entrants. In all the subjects she has taken, her instructors have always spoken highly of her work. As her Geography teacher, I can confirm that her intellect is worth engaging. Her work in Human Geography and Field Study classes was always very insightful. This is why when I was doing my Masters in Sustainable Urban Development thesis in waste management, I sought her reviews and acknowledged her helpful contributions accordingly.

This is only the first paragraph. You need two or three more paragraphs to talk about extracurricular activities, community service, etc. The same rules in the teacher recommendation apply here. REMEMBER TO ILLUSTRATE.

I hope you can draw the invaluable experience Edith has contributed to Loreto High School Limuru from the following examples and find her fit enough to admit to your institution. She will most certainly be eager to be considered, and it will change her entire life in unimaginable ways since she comes from a low-income family. You will certainly appreciate the level of work and out-of-class engagement she will bring to the school— all the best to her. *(As always, remember to say what an invaluable addition the applicant will be to the college)*

Regards,

(SIGNATURE)

Mrs. Celine Mutwiri,

School Counselor,
Loreto High School Limuru

(SCHOOL STAMP)